04-21 第一篇

Plants That Survive in the Desert

The desert is one of the harshest（恶劣的）places on Earth. It is hot, dry, and receives very little rain. Most plants cannot live in such conditions, yet some have found surprising ways to survive. [1] These plants, called xerophytes（旱生植物）, have developed special features over millions of years. Understanding how they live can help us appreciate the power of nature and even inspire new ideas for farming in dry areas.

One of the most famous desert plants is the cactus（仙人掌）. Its thick, fleshy stems store water like a sponge. [2] When rain finally comes, the cactus soaks up as much water as possible and saves it for the long dry months ahead. Its spines（刺）are actually modified leaves that reduce water loss and protect the plant from animals. Some cacti can live for months or even years without a single drop of rain.

Not all desert plants look like cacti. The roots of many desert plants grow very deep into the ground to reach underground water. Others have short roots that spread wide to catch rainwater quickly before it evaporates（蒸发）. [3] Some plants, like the resurrection plant（复活草）, can dry up completely and turn brown, but come back to life within hours after rain. Such different strategies show that there is more than one way to survive in the desert.

Desert plants also need to deal with the scorching（炙热的）sun. Many have small leaves or no leaves at all to reduce the surface area that loses water. [4] A waxy coating on the stems or leaves helps lock in moisture and reflects extra sunlight. Some plants even grow only at night or in the cool early morning. By adapting in these ways, they avoid the worst heat of the day.

[5] From the mighty saguaro（巨柱仙人掌）cactus to tiny wildflowers that bloom after rare rains, desert plants teach us an important lesson: life finds a way. They remind us that even in the toughest environments, nature can thrive with the right adaptations.

选项

A. In short, desert plants are masters of survival. B. Its thick skin keeps the stored water from escaping. C. In other words, desert plants use many different methods to stay alive. D. These special plants have learned to save water, find water, and protect themselves. E. Other adaptations focus on keeping water inside the plant. F. Research shows that some desert plants can live for over 100 years.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] D [2] B [3] C [4] E [5] A

深度解析

- **[1] D**：
  - **线索**：引出沙漠植物及其生存能力。空前描述沙漠"harsh...hot, dry...little rain...some have found surprising ways to survive"，空后说明"These plants, called xerophytes...have developed special features"。D选项"These special plants have learned to save water, find water, and protect themselves"（这些特殊植物学会了储水、找水并保护自己）中"These special plants"指代空前提到的survive的植物，"save water, find water, and protect themselves"概括后文将展开的三种策略，与空后"special features"完美呼应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：仙人掌储水机制的具体说明。空前描述"thick, fleshy stems store water like a sponge...When rain finally comes...soaks up...saves it...spines...reduce water loss"，空后需补充储水防流失的另一关键。B选项"Its thick skin keeps the stored water from escaping"（其厚皮能防止储存的水分流失）中"Its"指仙人掌，"stored water...escaping"与空前"store water...saves it"及后文"spines reduce water loss"形成完整的储水防流失逻辑链，衔接自然。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：多种沙漠植物策略的总结过渡。空前列举"roots grow very deep...short roots spread wide...resurrection plant...dry up...come back to life"，空后说明"Such different strategies show that there is more than one way to survive"。C选项"In other words, desert plants use many different methods to stay alive"（换言之，沙漠植物用许多不同的方法存活）中"In other words"承接空前多种例子，"many different methods"与空后"different strategies...more than one way"完美对应，逻辑紧密。
- **[4] E**：
  - **线索**：应对烈日与减少水分流失的承接。空前描述"small leaves or no leaves...reduce the surface area that loses water"，空后详述"waxy coating...locks in moisture...reflects extra sunlight...grow only at night"。E选项"Other adaptations focus on keeping water inside the plant"（其他适应策略则专注于把水分锁在植物内部）中"Other adaptations"与空前"small leaves...reduce"形成并列，"keeping water inside"与空后"waxy coating...locks in moisture"完美呼应，衔接精准。
- **[5] A**：

- **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后列举"From the mighty saguaro cactus to tiny wildflowers...bloom after rare rains"并总结"teach us...life finds a way...nature can thrive with the right adaptations"。A选项"In short, desert plants are masters of survival"（简言之，沙漠植物是生存大师）用"In short"总结全文，"masters of survival"与空后"life finds a way...thrive with adaptations"形成呼应，收束得当。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. Research shows that some desert plants can live for over 100 years.**：强调沙漠植物寿命，易被误填[1]或[5]。但全文主题为沙漠植物的"生存策略与适应"，F仅涉及"寿命"单一信息，无法承接空[1]的"special features"概述；空[5]需总结全文主旨，F的寿命陈述与"life finds a way...adaptations"的升华主题不匹配。属"主题相关但焦点偏离"型干扰。